**Table 1.** Coercive control categories, after Stark (2023).

| # | Category | Mechanism | Tactics (pp.) |
|---|---|---|---|
| *Disembodied* | | | |
| 1 | **Threat** | Elicits existential fear and turns compliance into the target's self-interest | • threat of physical harm (366)<br>• threat of murder (366)<br>• threat of withholding affection or attention (371)<br>• threat of leaving the relationship (371)<br>• threat of suicide or self-harm (371)<br>• destruction of property as display of capacity to harm (371) |
| 2 | **Surveillance** | Makes the target constantly visible to the controller | • monitoring behavior to gather information without the target's knowledge (373)<br>• enforcing behavioral constraints by letting the target know she is being watched (373) |
| 3 | **Regulation** | Colonizes everyday routines to remove autonomy | • setting the terms of every encounter (308)<br>• training the target to respond to cues (308)<br>• routine or random check-ins (377)<br>• control over minutiae across realms: work, home, other relationships, driving (377)<br>• written rules and lists (399)<br>• rules discovered only once broken (413) |
| 4 | **Degradation** | Reduces the target's standing | • name-calling (379)<br>• treating her like an animal (379)<br>• public embarrassment (379)<br>• enforcing intrinsically humiliating behaviors (381)<br>• punishments normally used to discipline a child (381) |
| 5 | **Isolation** | Cuts off the target from outside support | • isolation from family of origin (385–389)<br>• isolation from friends (390–391)<br>• isolation from work (393–395)<br>• isolation from help (396–397)<br>• locating and destroying safety zones (385) |
| 6 | **Reality control** | Makes the target dependent on the controller's version of events | • gaslighting (372–373)<br>• convincing others she is crazy (372)<br>• threatening to have her committed (372)<br>• positioning himself as her primary source of interpretation and validation (384) |
| 7 | **Identity imposition** | Imposes an identity crafted by the controller onto the target | • ownership contracts (308)<br>• marking (381)<br>• imposing stereotyped role identity (315)<br>• colonizing the self until she has no private inner life (384) |
| 8 | **Sexual control** | Controls the target's sexuality | • sexual rules and contracts (400)<br>• pressuring for sex through the silent treatment, withdrawal, or withholding sex or affection (356)<br>• regulating sexual presentation (355) |
| 9 | **Material deprivation** | Controls access to basic necessities | • limiting access to money (397–398)<br>• controlling food (399)<br>• restricting transportation (398)<br>• controlling communication (399) |
| 10 | **Resource exploitation** | Appropriates the target's capacities and resources | • theft of money (397)<br>• coercing unpaid labor (398)<br>• exchanging money she is entitled to for services (398)<br>• taking money through deceit and fraud (398)<br>• forcing her earnings to cover household expenses (398) |
| 11 | **Instrumental affection** | Disguises control as care | • requests and gifts framed as care (335–336)<br>• post-abuse reconciliation as manipulation (359)<br>• love as a justification for isolation (391)<br>• rules delivered with declarations of love (393) |
| 12 | **Protective leverage** | Turns the target's care for others into leverage | • threats against her friends or family (366–367)<br>• threats to hurt the children (368)<br>• threats to take the children away (366, 369)<br>• forcing her to take part in harming the children (382) |
| *Embodied* | | | |
| 13 | **Physical violence** | Uses bodily force to harm, dominate, and prevent escape | • routine, low-level violence (359)<br>• severe assault (352) |
| 14 | **Sexual violence** | Uses sex as a form of bodily or emotional harm | • rape and sexual assault (356)<br>• use of and forced participation in pornography (356)<br>• sexual inspections and other explicitly sexual humiliation (356) |
| 15 | **Reproductive control** | Controls whether and when the target reproduces | • forced pregnancy (356)<br>• forced abortion (356) |
| 16 | **Stalking** | Tracks and pursues the target in physical spaces | • tracking and pursuing the target in person (374) |

Source: Stark, *Coercive Control*, 2nd ed. (2023), chs. 7–9. Page numbers refer to the working full-text PDF.